Send email to manager from database team to discuss on RDS costs reduction efforts and collectively collaborate

Thought for a couple of seconds >

Subject: Collaboration on RDS Cost Reduction Efforts

Hi [Manager Name],

I would like to set up a discussion with the Database Team to review our current RDS costs and identify opportunities for cost reduction.

We are currently seeing RDS costs driven by database instance usage, replicas, storage, snapshots, and reservation coverage. It would be helpful to collectively review the current setup and collaborate on possible optimization areas, such as:

- Right-sizing RDS instances based on CPU, memory, and usage patterns
- Reviewing read replica usage and confirming whether all replicas are required
- Evaluating Reserved Instance coverage and gaps
- Reviewing storage, backup retention, and snapshot costs
- Considering Aurora Serverless or other cost-effective options where applicable
- Identifying any underutilized or non-production databases that can be stopped, resized, or scheduled

Could we schedule time with the Database Team to walk through the current RDS environment and align on recommended cost reduction actions?

Thanks,
[Your Name]

So we have setup a meeting and now want to check with dba team so what should the agenda be in terms of driving the cost

Here is a strong agenda you can use for the meeting with the DBA team.

Meeting Title: RDS Cost Optimization Review with DBA Team

Objective:
Review current RDS usage and cost drivers, identify optimization opportunities, and agree on action items to reduce database spend without impacting application performance or availability.

Agenda

1. Current RDS Cost Overview

Discuss what is driving the current RDS cost.

Topics:

- Monthly RDS spend trend
- Top cost-driving RDS instances
- Cost split by database engines, such as PostgreSQL, MySQL, SQL Server, Oracle, Aurora
- Primary vs read replica cost contribution
- Storage, backup, snapshot, and data transfer costs
- Any recent cost spikes or unusual usage patterns

2. Instance Right-Sizing Review

Validate whether current RDS instance sizes match actual workload needs.

Questions to ask:

- Are any RDS instances over-provisioned?
- What are the average and peak CPU, memory, IOPS, and connection usage?
- Can any instances be moved to smaller instance classes?
- Are we using older generation instances that can be upgraded to newer, more cost-efficient types?
- Are production and non-production databases sized differently?

3. Read Replica and Multi-AZ Review

Review whether HA and replica configurations are still required as currently deployed.

Questions to ask:

- Which databases have read replicas?
- Are the replicas actively used by applications or reporting jobs?
- Are any replicas idle or underutilized?
- Is Multi-AZ required for all databases, or only critical production workloads?
- Can non-production replicas be removed?

4. Reserved Instance and Savings Opportunity

Review reservation coverage and purchasing strategy.

Questions to ask:

- Which RDS instances are covered by Reserved Instances?
- Are any RIs underutilized?
- Are there uncovered steady-state databases that should be reserved?
- Are existing RIs aligned to the right database engine, region, and instance family?
- Do we need 1-year or 3-year RIs for stable production workloads?

5. Storage, Backup, and Snapshot Optimization

Review storage growth and backup retention settings.

Questions to ask:

- Are storage allocations higher than actual usage?
- Are any databases over-provisioned on storage?
- Are backup retention periods aligned with business requirements?
- Are old manual snapshots still needed?
- Are snapshots being copied cross-region unnecessarily?
- Are there old databases with retained backups that can be deleted?

6. Non-Production Database Scheduling

Discuss reducing cost for dev, test, QA, and staging databases.

Questions to ask:

- Which non-prod RDS instances can be stopped after business hours?
- Can start/stop schedules be applied using tags?
- Are any non-prod databases running 24/7 unnecessarily?
- Can lower instance sizes be used for non-prod?
- Can non-prod backups/snapshots have shorter retention?

7. Aurora / Serverless / Modernization Options

Evaluate whether any workloads can move to a more cost-effective architecture.

Questions to ask:

- Are any workloads good candidates for Aurora Serverless v2?
- Are there variable or unpredictable workloads where serverless may help?
- Are there workloads currently using provisioned instances but idle most of the time?
- Are there licensing or engine-specific constraints?
- What migration effort would be required?

8. Operational Risks and Constraints

Make sure cost savings do not create performance, availability, or compliance issues.

Questions to ask:

- Which databases are business-critical?
- What are the uptime and recovery requirements?
- Are there compliance or audit retention requirements?
- What performance thresholds should not be crossed?
- What changes require application team approval?

9. Action Plan and Ownership

End with clear next steps.

Capture:

- Optimization opportunity
- Database/resource name
- Expected cost impact
- Risk level
- Owner
- Target date
- Required approvals

Suggested Meeting Close

You can say:

"Based on today's review, we would like to come out with a prioritized list of RDS cost optimization actions. The goal is not just to cut cost, but to identify safe opportunities where we can right-size, reduce unused capacity, improve RI coverage, clean up storage/snapshots, and apply scheduling for non-production workloads."

Simple Email/Meeting Agenda Text

Subject: Agenda for RDS Cost Optimization Discussion

Hi Team,

For our upcoming RDS cost optimization discussion, below is the proposed agenda:

1. Review current RDS cost drivers and top contributing databases
2. Validate instance sizing based on CPU, memory, IOPS, storage, and connection usage
3. Review read replicas, Multi-AZ usage, and HA requirements
4. Check Reserved Instance coverage, utilization, and future purchase opportunities
5. Review storage, backup retention, manual snapshots, and cross-region snapshot costs
6. Identify non-production databases that can be stopped, resized, or scheduled
7. Evaluate Aurora Serverless or other modernization opportunities where applicable
8. Discuss operational, performance, compliance, and application dependencies
9. Agree on owners, next steps, and target dates for cost reduction actions

The goal is to collaboratively identify safe and practical RDS cost reduction opportunities without impacting performance, availability, or business requirements.

Thanks,
[Your Name]

Sources

In meeting what questons from cloud team that needs to route or ask dba/rds team

Below are strong **cloud team questions** to ask the **DBA/RDS team** during the RDS cost reduction meeting.

1. Current RDS Usage and Ownership

1. Which RDS databases are business-critical production systems?
2. Which databases are non-prod, dev, test, QA, staging, or temporary?
3. Are there any RDS instances no longer used but still running?
4. Who is the application owner for each high-cost RDS instance?
5. Are all RDS instances properly tagged with application, environment, owner, and cost center?

2. Instance Sizing / Right-Sizing

1. Are the current RDS instance classes sized based on actual workload metrics or initial estimates?
2. Can we review CPU, memory, database connections, IOPS, throughput, and storage usage for the top-cost RDS instances?
3. Are any databases consistently underutilized?
4. Can any instances be downsized safely?
5. Are any instances using older generation instance families that can be moved to newer, more cost-efficient families?
6. For each large instance, what is the technical reason for the current size?
7. Do we need the current size all day, or only during peak processing windows?

3. Read Replicas and Multi-AZ

1. Which RDS instances have read replicas?
2. Are the read replicas actively used by applications, reporting, analytics, or DR?
3. Are there any idle or low-utilization replicas that can be removed?
4. Do all current read replicas need the same instance size as the primary?
5. Which RDS instances are Multi-AZ enabled?
6. Is Multi-AZ required for all those databases, or only critical production workloads?
7. Can Multi-AZ be disabled for any non-prod or lower-tier workloads?

4. Reserved Instances / Commitment Coverage

1. Which RDS instances are steady-state and expected to run continuously for the next 12 months?
2. Which RDS workloads are already covered by Reserved Instances?
3. Are any active RDS instances not covered by RIs but good candidates for RI purchase?
4. Are any existing RIs underutilized or mismatched with current RDS usage?
5. Are we planning any migrations, upgrades, or decommissions that would affect RI purchasing decisions?
6. Should we consider 1-year RIs for stable workloads and avoid commitment for workloads expected to change?

5. Storage, Backups, and Snapshots

1. Which databases have the highest allocated storage?
2. Is allocated storage close to actual usage, or are we over-provisioned?
3. Are any RDS instances using high-cost storage options unnecessarily?
4. What backup retention period is required for each environment?
5. Can non-prod backup retention be reduced?
6. Are there old manual snapshots that can be deleted?
7. Are there retained automated backups from deleted databases that are no longer needed?
8. Are snapshots copied to another region? If yes, is that still required?
9. Are storage growth trends being reviewed regularly?

6. Non-Production Cost Reduction

1. Which non-prod databases can be stopped outside business hours?
2. Are there any dev/test databases that need to run 24/7?
3. Can we apply start/stop scheduling using tags?

4. Can non-prod databases be downsized?
5. Can non-prod databases use reduced backup retention?
6. Can non-prod read replicas or Multi-AZ configurations be removed?
7. Are there sandbox or temporary RDS instances that should have automatic expiration dates?

7. Performance and Risk Validation

1. What minimum CPU, memory, IOPS, storage, and connection thresholds should we maintain?
2. What metrics should cloud team review before recommending downsizing?
3. What performance risk would be introduced by downsizing each high-cost database?
4. Are there known performance issues that require the current instance size?
5. Do any databases have seasonal or month-end workload spikes?
6. Are there batch jobs, reporting jobs, or ETL workloads that drive temporary peaks?
7. What testing is required before resizing production databases?

8. Engine / Architecture Optimization

1. Are any workloads candidates for Aurora?
2. Are any workloads candidates for Aurora Serverless v2?
3. Are there variable workloads where serverless may reduce cost?
4. Are any databases good candidates for consolidation?
5. Are there multiple small databases that can be combined safely?
6. Are any workloads using commercial database engines where license cost is a major driver?
7. Are we using features that require the current engine or edition?

9. Decommissioning and Cleanup

1. Are there databases created for old projects that can be deleted?
2. Are there databases tied to retired applications?
3. Are there snapshots from decommissioned databases that can be removed?
4. Can we create an approval process for deleting unused RDS resources?
5. Can every temporary database have an expiration date tag?

10. Governance and Ongoing Monitoring

1. What cost and usage metrics should be monitored regularly?
2. Can DBA team provide monthly validation of high-cost RDS resources?
3. Should we set CloudWatch alarms for underutilized RDS instances?
4. Should we create a recurring RDS optimization review?
5. What tagging standards should be enforced for RDS?
6. Can we define an approval process for creating large RDS instances, read replicas, or Multi-AZ databases?
7. Should any RDS cost changes require DBA review before implementation?

Best Questions to Prioritize in the Meeting

Use these if time is limited:

1. Which top-cost RDS instances are safe candidates for right-sizing?
2. Which read replicas are actively used, and which can be removed?
3. Which non-prod databases can be stopped after hours?

4. Are all Multi-AZ databases truly required to be Multi-AZ?
5. Are backup retention and snapshots aligned with actual business requirements?
6. Are there old manual snapshots or retained backups that can be deleted?
7. Which steady-state databases should be covered by Reserved Instances?
8. Are there any planned migrations or retirements that would impact RI decisions?
9. What performance thresholds should cloud team use before recommending changes?
10. Who owns each action item, and what is the target date?

Simple Way to Open the Discussion

You can say:

"From the cloud team side, we want to partner with the DBA team to identify safe RDS cost optimization opportunities. We are not looking to make changes without DBA validation. We want to review sizing, replicas, Multi-AZ, storage, backups, snapshots, RI coverage, and non-prod scheduling, then agree on practical actions with owners and timelines."

what is scope of work for cloud team and for rds team

Thought for a couple of seconds

Below is a clear **scope of work split** between the **Cloud Team** and the **DBA/RDS Team** for RDS cost reduction.

Scope of Work: Cloud Team

The **Cloud Team** should drive the cost visibility, governance, automation, and cloud infrastructure changes.

1. Cost Analysis and Reporting

Cloud Team owns:

- Identify top RDS cost drivers by account, region, database, engine, and environment
- Pull cost data from AWS Cost Explorer, CUR, Apptio, or billing tools
- Break down costs by:
  - DB instance usage
  - Read replicas
  - Multi-AZ
  - Storage
  - Backup storage
  - Snapshots
  - Data transfer
  - Reserved Instance coverage
- Share monthly RDS cost trend reports
- Highlight unusual cost spikes or growth patterns

2. AWS Tagging and Ownership

Cloud Team owns:

- Validate that RDS resources have required tags:
  - Application
  - Environment
  - Owner
  - Cost center
  - Business unit
  - Support team
- Identify untagged or incorrectly tagged RDS resources
- Work with application and DBA teams to fix missing tags
- Enforce tagging through policies, Terraform, Service Catalog, or governance controls

3. RI / Savings Opportunity Analysis

Cloud Team owns:

- Review RDS Reserved Instance coverage and utilization
- Identify steady-state RDS workloads not covered by reservations
- Identify unused or underutilized RIs
- Recommend RI purchase options after DBA validation
- Coordinate with finance, procurement, or FinOps team
- Avoid RI purchases for databases planned for migration, resizing, or decommissioning

4. Infrastructure Change Execution

Cloud Team may own or support:

- RDS instance resizing through Terraform, CloudFormation, or AWS Console
- Applying approved start/stop schedules for non-prod RDS
- Implementing AWS Instance Scheduler or automation using tags
- Creating CloudWatch alarms and dashboards
- Updating IaC code for approved changes
- Coordinating maintenance windows for changes

5. Automation and Governance

Cloud Team owns:

- Build automation to stop/start non-prod RDS where approved
- Create alerts for cost anomalies or underutilized databases
- Create dashboards for CPU, memory, IOPS, storage, connections, and cost
- Create governance process for:
  - Large RDS instance creation
  - Read replica creation
  - Multi-AZ enablement
  - Long backup retention
  - Manual snapshot retention
- Document standards for cost-optimized RDS deployments

6. CloudWatch and Monitoring

Cloud Team owns:

- Provide RDS utilization metrics from CloudWatch
- Create dashboards for high-cost RDS instances
- Track:
    - CPUUtilization
    - FreeableMemory
    - DatabaseConnections
    - ReadIOPS / WriteIOPS
    - ReadLatency / WriteLatency
    - FreeStorageSpace
    - DiskQueueDepth
    - NetworkThroughput
- Share metric evidence with DBA team before recommending changes

Scope of Work: DBA / RDS Team

The **DBA/RDS Team** should own database performance, availability, configuration validation, and technical approval for database changes.

1. Database Criticality and Usage Validation

DBA Team owns:

- Confirm which databases are production, non-prod, critical, or temporary
- Validate which databases are actively used
- Identify databases that are idle or no longer needed
- Confirm application dependencies
- Confirm business impact of changing or stopping databases

2. Performance Review and Right-Sizing Approval

DBA Team owns:

- Review performance metrics before resizing
- Validate whether current instance class is required
- Confirm safe downsizing options
- Identify performance risks
- Define acceptable thresholds for:
    - CPU
    - Memory
    - Connections
    - IOPS
    - Latency
    - Storage growth
- Confirm testing required before production changes

3. Read Replica and Multi-AZ Validation

DBA Team owns:

- Confirm which read replicas are required
- Validate whether replicas are used for:
    - Application reads
    - Reporting
    - Analytics

    - DR
    - Backup/offload purposes
- Approve removal or resizing of unused replicas
- Confirm where Multi-AZ is mandatory
- Identify non-prod databases where Multi-AZ can be disabled

4. Backup, Snapshot, and Retention Review

DBA Team owns:

- Define backup retention requirements
- Confirm compliance or audit retention needs
- Approve reduction of backup retention for non-prod
- Identify old manual snapshots that can be deleted
- Confirm whether cross-region snapshots are required
- Validate retained backups from deleted databases

5. Maintenance Window and Change Approval

DBA Team owns:

- Approve timing of RDS changes
- Define maintenance windows
- Support resizing, failover, or restart activities
- Validate database health after changes
- Coordinate with application teams when downtime or testing is needed

6. Database Engine and Architecture Recommendations

DBA Team owns:

- Evaluate whether workloads are good candidates for:
    - Aurora
    - Aurora Serverless v2
    - Instance family changes
    - Database consolidation
    - Engine upgrades
- Validate migration complexity
- Confirm compatibility, performance, and operational risks

Shared Scope Between Cloud Team and DBA Team

Some work should be jointly owned.

Area	Cloud Team Role	DBA/RDS Team Role
Cost review	Provide billing and cost data	Validate technical reason for cost
Right-sizing	Provide utilization metrics and recommendation	Approve safe target size
RI planning	Identify reservation gaps	Confirm workload stability
Start/stop scheduling	Build automation	Approve eligible databases

Area	Cloud Team Role	DBA/RDS Team Role
Snapshot cleanup	Identify old snapshots and cost	Approve deletion
Multi-AZ/read replica review	Identify cost impact	Confirm business/technical need
Monitoring	Build dashboards and alarms	Define thresholds
Change execution	Implement approved infra changes	Validate database health
Governance	Create policy/guardrails	Define database standards

Simple Scope Statement You Can Use in Meeting

You can say:

"The Cloud Team will drive cost visibility, reporting, tagging, RI analysis, automation, monitoring, and implementation of approved infrastructure changes. The DBA Team will validate database usage, performance, criticality, backup requirements, HA requirements, and approve any changes that may impact database availability or performance. Together, we will identify safe RDS cost optimization opportunities and agree on owners, timelines, and expected savings."

Recommended Action Item Format

Use this format during the meeting:

Action Item	Owner	Support Team	Risk	Expected Savings	Target Date
Review top 10 RDS cost drivers	Cloud Team	DBA Team	Low	TBD	TBD
Validate right-sizing candidates	DBA Team	Cloud Team	Medium	TBD	TBD
Identify unused read replicas	DBA Team	Cloud Team	Medium	TBD	TBD
Review RI coverage	Cloud Team	DBA Team	Low	TBD	TBD
Clean up old snapshots	DBA Team	Cloud Team	Low/Medium	TBD	TBD
Apply non-prod stop/start schedule	Cloud Team	DBA Team	Medium	TBD	TBD

Clean Responsibility Split

Cloud Team owns: cost, visibility, automation, governance, tagging, RI analysis, dashboards, implementation.

DBA/RDS Team owns: database performance, availability, backup/retention requirements, technical validation, approvals, and post-change health checks.

any template or excel that we can use

I'll create a practical Excel tracker you can use in the meeting, with tabs for cost drivers, optimization candidates, DBA validation, RI coverage, snapshots, and action items.

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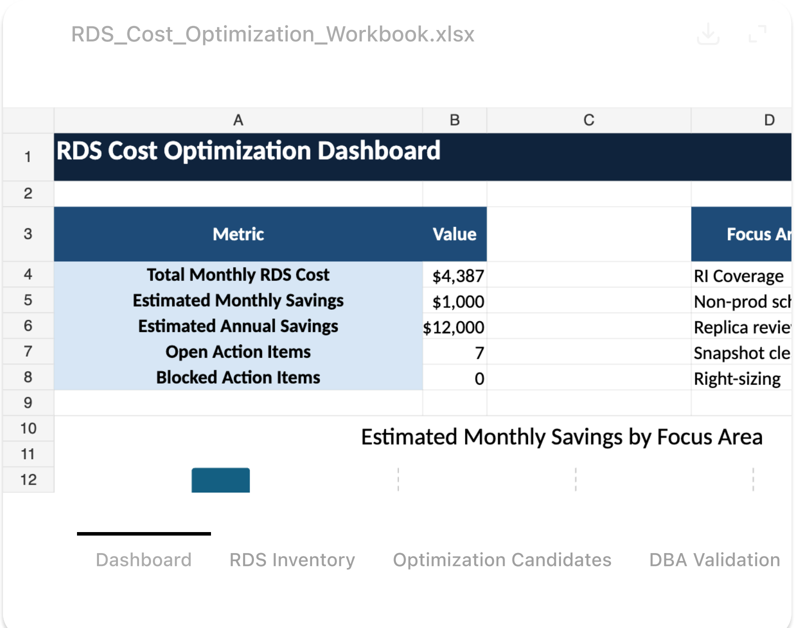
Yes — I created an Excel workbook you can use for the RDS cost-reduction meeting.


RDS_Cost_Optimization_Workbook.xlsx

	A	B	C	D
1	RDS Cost Optimization Dashboard			
2				
3	Metric	Value		Focus Ar
4	Total Monthly RDS Cost	$4,387		RI Coverage
5	Estimated Monthly Savings	$1,000		Non-prod scl
6	Estimated Annual Savings	$12,000		Replica revie
7	Open Action Items	7		Snapshot cle
8	Blocked Action Items	0		Right-sizing
9				
10	Estimated Monthly Savings by Focus Area			
11				
12				

Dashboard | RDS Inventory | Optimization Candidates | DBA Validation

It includes these tabs:

- **Dashboard** – summary of total RDS cost, estimated savings, open actions, and focus areas
- **RDS Inventory** – account, region, DB identifier, engine, instance class, storage, CPU, memory, cost, replicas
- **Optimization Candidates** – right-sizing, RI coverage, scheduling, replica review, savings estimate, risk, status
- **DBA Validation** – checklist for DBA approval, performance risk, backup, Multi-AZ, replica requirements
- **RI Coverage** – Reserved Instance review and purchase candidate tracking
- **Snapshots & Backups** – snapshot/backup cleanup and retention review
- **Action Items** – owners, target dates, priority, risk, status, dependencies
- **Dropdowns** – supporting dropdown values for status, risk, priority, decisions, environment